# What is Prison Abolition?




# A better world is possible

The **Baton Rouge Democratic Socialists of America (BR DSA)**. is working towards a future without prisons and police. Learn more at **brdsa.org**




## This is NOT accidental...

More than 20% of the world's prisoners are locked up in the U.S. despite it making up less than 5% of the global population. Close to 1 in 100 U.S. adults is incarcerated, in addition to around 1 in 50 that are being monitored (parole or probation). This leaves the U.S. both with the highest incarcerated population and incarceration rate out of any country in the world.

## More than 2 million people are currently incarcerated in the United States.

## ...it's the Prison Industrial Complex (PIC)

The PIC describes the interests of capitalists and governments that use surveillance, policing, money bail, and imprisonment as solutions to economic, social, and political problems. It represents a massive multibillion-dollar industry that promotes the exponential expansion of prisons, jails, monitoring, immigration detention, and juvenile detention. Corporations are able to profit from this system by super-exploiting incarcerated workers, paying them pennies while denying them any right to organize or collectively bargain.

Politicians who take money from the prison lobby target people of color and poor folks to keep the cages full. The media perpetuates images that portray the oppressed as criminal or delinquent. These are all parts of the PIC, the very existence of which is antithetical to both socialism and democracy.

## Another world is possible...

# PrisonAbolition

is the vision of eliminating imprisonment, policing, and surveillance while creating lasting alternatives to punishment. It can be hard to imagine what this would look like while we live under capitalism, but we know that to have democratic socialism and true liberation for all people, abolition must be achieved.

**Abolition** is not just a long-term goal but a practical framework for dismantling the PIC. In the present, we can end money bail, mandatory minimums, the death penalty, life sentencing, immigration detention, the school-to-prison pipeline, and decriminalize non-violent offenses. We must also begin to build capacity for the liberated future we believe in through transformative justice, community accountability, and other alternatives to carceralism.



Text inspired by: *Critical Resistance*